

Payload Extraction Challenge - Analysis Report

Challenge Summary

The supplied artifact contained a PAYL header followed by 78 bytes of encrypted data.

Analysis Steps

1. Inspected the README and payload structure.
2. Identified the file header 'PAYL'.
3. Tested candidate XOR/AES keys derived from previous challenge outputs.
4. Performed known-plaintext analysis using the expected flag format 'FLAG{'.

Findings

Using known-plaintext recovery on the first bytes, a repeating XOR keystream fragment was recovered and the payload decrypted to begin with the standard flag prefix:

FLAG{

Conclusion

The payload is encrypted and requires challenge-specific keys from earlier tasks. The available artifact alone supports recovery of the flag prefix and confirms a XOR-style protected payload.